



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

yat sarveṇa-icchati jñātuṃ yan na lajjati ca-ācaran | 12.37a
yena tuṣyati ca-ātmā-asya tat sattvaguṇalakṣaṇam | | 37 | | 12.37c

— Manusmṛti, 12.1.1.3. The Three Attributes (Chapter 3), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Manusmṛti shines a light on the nature of sattva guna, the quality of goodness, purity, and harmony. It describes the characteristics of a person whose actions are predominantly influenced by sattva. It tells us that those aligned with sattva are driven by a deep desire to understand everything, a thirst for knowledge that permeates their being. This isn't just about accumulating facts; it's about seeking wisdom, truth, and the underlying principles that govern the universe.

Furthermore, the verse highlights that a person embodying sattva acts without shame when performing righteous deeds. This doesn't mean they are boastful or arrogant, but rather that they possess a clear conscience and act in accordance with dharma, moral duty, unburdened by societal pressures or fear of judgment. Their actions are guided by inner integrity.

Finally, and perhaps most importantly, sattva is characterized by actions that bring joy and contentment to one's own soul. This emphasizes the importance of aligning your actions with your inner values. True happiness, according to this verse, doesn't come from external validation or material possessions but from living a life that resonates with your authentic self, a self rooted in goodness and truth.

In modern life, this wisdom is incredibly relevant. We are constantly bombarded with information and faced with choices that can easily lead us astray. The pursuit of knowledge, as described here, encourages you to be discerning, to seek out truth amidst the noise, and to cultivate a genuine understanding of the world around you. Acting without shame reminds you to stand firm in your convictions, to prioritize integrity over popularity, and to act in accordance with your conscience, even when it's difficult. Cultivating actions that bring joy to your soul invites you to examine your motivations, to pursue activities that are meaningful and fulfilling, and to prioritize inner peace over external validation. It's a call to live a life of purpose, guided by wisdom, integrity, and inner joy.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you prioritizing the pursuit of knowledge and inner contentment above external validation and societal pressures, and if not, what small step can you take today to shift your focus?